

Operation Handwriting, Plan

Dar Al-Ulum Montreal. 10 school days, 60 minutes per day, same slot daily. Suggested dates: Monday 21 September to Friday 2 October 2026.

Groups: Cycle 1 (grades 1 and 2), Cycle 2 (grades 3 and 4), Cycle 3 (grades 5 and 6).

Scripts: Cycle 1 print. Cycle 2 print repair (Days 1 and 2) then cursive. Cycle 3 cursive fluency, speed, presentation. Lead teacher moves a group one track up or down after the Day 1 diagnostic if needed.

Language: worksheets are letter-based and work in English and French. Test passage exists in both. Each student tests in the language of their main writing class.

1. Target

Day 1 and Day 10: same test passage, scored on the 24-point rubric. Target: average gain of 6 points per cycle, no student under 12 on Day 10. Under 12 on Day 10: four weeks of 10 minutes daily in homeroom, then re-test.

2. The hour

Minutes	Block	Content
0 to 5	Warm-up	Posture check, grip check, warm-up card
5 to 15	Direct teaching	Teacher models on the board, says the pathway. Air writing, desk writing, one on paper
15 to 35	Guided practice	Worksheet of the day. Teacher circulates: posture, grip, formation
35 to 50	Applied writing	Sentence, paragraph or dictation on lined paper
50 to 57	Feedback	Student circles best letter. Teacher: one star, one wish
57 to 60	Tracker	Progress chart, sheets into folder

The 60 minutes are not shortened or split.

3. Ten days per cycle

Cycle 1, print

Day	Focus	Letters and skills	Worksheet
1	Diagnostic	Pre-test. Posture, grip, paper position. Pattern strokes	Pre-test sheet, Pattern sheet
2	Straight line family	l, i, t. Capitals L, I, T, H, E, F	Print sheet A
3	Round family	c, o, a, d, g, q	Print sheet B
4	Bump family	r, n, m, h, b, p	Print sheet C
5	Tricky family	e, s, f, k, u, v, w, x, y, z, j	Print sheets D and E
6	Capitals and sizes	All capitals. Tall, small, tail letters	Capitals sheets, Size sort sheet
7	Spacing and baseline	Finger spaces, letters on the line	Spacing sheet
8	Sentences	Copying sentences. Numbers 0 to 9	Sentence sheet 1, Numbers sheet
9	Dictation	Six sentences	Lined paper C1

10	Post-test	Post-test, compare with Day 1, certificates	Post-test sheet, Certificate
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Cycle 2, print repair then cursive

Day	Focus	Letters and skills	Worksheet
1	Diagnostic	Pre-test. Posture, grip. Self-check	Pre-test sheet, Self-check sheet
2	Print repair	Size, baseline, spacing. Rewrite Day 1 sample	Size and spacing sheet, Lined paper C2
3	Undercurve family	Entry and exit strokes. i, u, w, t	Cursive sheet A
4	Loop family	e, l, h, k, b, f	Cursive sheet B
5	Round family	a, d, g, q, c, o	Cursive sheet C
6	Overcurve family	n, m, v, x, y, z	Cursive sheet D
7	Remaining letters, joins	r, s, p, j. Two- and three-letter joins	Cursive sheet E, Joins sheet
8	Cursive capitals	A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P R S T W	Cursive capitals sheets
9	Paragraph and dictation	Paragraph in cursive, four dictated sentences	Sentence sheet 2
10	Post-test	Post-test in stronger script, compare, certificates	Post-test sheet, Certificate

Cycle 3, fluency and presentation

Day	Focus	Skills	Worksheet
1	Diagnostic	Pre-test. Self-score with rubric, three targets	Pre-test sheet, Self-check sheet
2	Grip and pressure	Pressure test, tripod grip, consistent size	Size and spacing sheet
3	Slant and baseline	One slant, letters on the line	Slant sheet
4	Spacing	Letter spacing, word spacing, margins	Spacing sheet
5	Join repair	Joins after o, v, w, b. Mid-word r and s	Joins sheet
6	Capitals and numbers	Cursive capitals, numbers, dates, headings	Cursive capitals sheets, Numbers sheet
7	Speed	Timed copying, 1, 3, 5 minutes. Legible words per minute	Speed sheet
8	Dictation	Passage at speaking pace, then clean copy	Dictation sheet
9	Presentation	Final copy: title, date, margin, indent	Presentation sheets
10	Post-test	Post-test, compare, certificates	Post-test sheet, Certificate

4. Roles

Principal: launch message, walk-through Days 1, 5 and 10, receives scores Day 10. Lead teacher per cycle: runs the hour, scores tests, keeps tracking sheet, hands in scores Day 10. All subject teachers: illegible work is handed back to be rewritten, every class, both weeks. Assistants: guided practice block, five weakest students per group, separate table.

5. Materials per group

Print before Day 1: folder per student, pre-test and post-test sheets, daily worksheets for the cycle, 20 sheets of the cycle's lined paper per student, progress chart per student, tracking sheet and rubric per teacher, warm-up card and posture poster, certificate per student.

Physical: HB pencils, erasers, triangular pencil grips for fist or thumb-wrap grips, slant board or thick binder for heavy pressers. No pens for Cycles 1 and 2.

6. Data

Day 1: pre-test scored same day, entered on tracking sheet. Day 5: students not moving are marked, they get the assistant table from Day 6. Day 10: post-test scored, entered, average gain per group. Sheet to principal with the under-12 list.

Report to principal per cycle: average pre-test, average post-test, number under 12.

7. After

Subject teachers keep returning illegible work. Homerooms keep 5 minutes of copying at the start of the first writing period for the rest of the term. Under-12 list: 10 minutes daily with lead teacher for four weeks, re-test.

Arabic script is not covered. Same structure, own letter families, separate module.